

mvp1.com.au Search Audit

A full technical and content audit of the site, a month-by-month read of May through August 2026, and a claim-by-claim verification of the 34 deliverables in the agency's Drive folder, checked against live Search Console and GA4 data.

Prepared 31 August 2026 Property <https://mvp1.com.au/> GA4 476568741 Pages crawled 53 Deliverables reviewed 34

ORGANIC CLICKS	IMPRESSIONS	AVG. POSITION	NON-BRAND CLICKS	TARGETS RANKING
103	1,945	16.4	1	1/17
▼ 49% vs April	▼ 60% vs April	▼ 8.0 places	flat at ~0 all year	16 never seen

The verdict summary

Four months of SEO work have coincided with organic search performance falling by roughly half. The site itself is technically sound, so the problem is not the website. The problem is that almost none of the work billed against it was aimed at, or capable of, moving commercial rankings.

CONTRADICTED

6

Claims the live site or the raw data disproves as written.

HOLLOW

3

Deliverables that are empty, byte-identical duplicates, or another client's work.

PARTLY VERIFIED

2

Consistent with the data, but not provable from the sources reachable here.

VERIFIED

4

Work genuinely done, live and confirmed today.

The one number that settles it

Strip out people searching for mvp1, mvp1 ventures and mvp ventures, the people who already know the company, and what remains is the traffic SEO is actually paid to create. That number is **0 to 1 clicks per month**, and it has not moved since March. Of the 17 commercial keywords the agency mapped across four months, **one** has ever registered a single impression: private ai infrastructure, which drew 9 impressions and no clicks in May, then disappeared.

Everything else in this report explains why.

Live account credentials are sitting in a publicly-readable Drive folder

The folder shared for this review is set to **"anyone with the link can view"**. At least four files inside it contain the plaintext password for mvpausqld@gmail.com, the Google account that controls the Google Business Profile, along with the recovery email and recovery phone number.

Affected files: Month 1 / ...CUSTOM_Final_Report.xls, Month 3 / ...GEO_SEO_Month_2_CUSTOM_Final_Report.xls (both in a "Package Reports" tab), Month 3 / ...Australia_Claim_and_Verification_Report.pdf, and the "CP" content-posting tabs, which additionally expose the same password reused for Medium and Tumblr accounts. A second, different password for the same Gmail address appears in the Australia claim report.

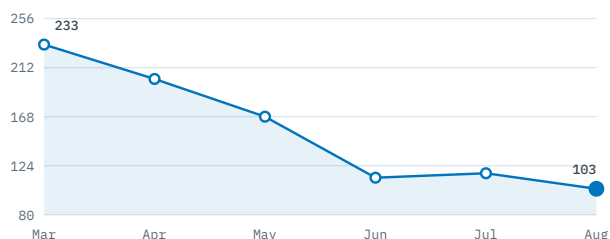
Do this now: change the Google account password and revoke active sessions; rotate the Medium and Tumblr passwords; change the recovery phone and email; turn the Drive folder's link sharing off; then review Business Profile edit history for changes you did not authorise. Password reuse across the Google account and third-party publishing accounts means one leak compromises all of them.

What actually happened Mar-Aug 2026

The engagement's own benchmark report covers 16 March – 14 April, so March and April are the honest "before". Every organic metric has fallen since, and the decline is steepest in the months with the most billed activity.

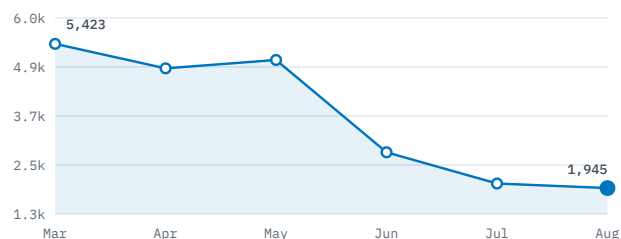
Organic clicks

Search Console, all queries. Peak was March, before the engagement.



Impressions

How often the site appeared at all, down 60% since April.



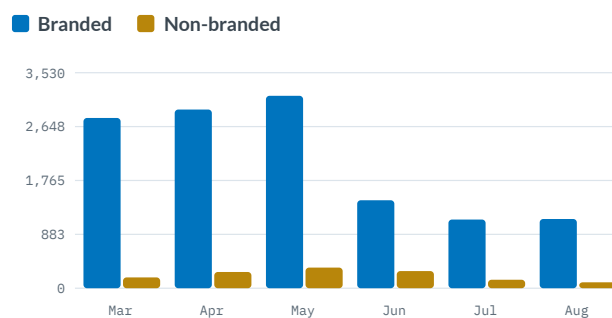
Average position

Lower is better. The axis is inverted so down still means worse.



Branded vs non-branded impressions

Non-branded is the half SEO is paid to grow. It is the smaller bar every month.



Read this before drawing conclusions about cause

Branded impressions fell as hard as non-branded ones, from 2,927 in April to 1,134 in August. Rankings for those brand terms held steady around position 5–6 throughout. That pattern means fewer people searched for MVP1, not that the site lost brand rankings. Part of this decline is falling brand demand, which is a marketing problem rather than an SEO execution failure, and it would be unfair to lay all of it at the agency's door. What the agency *is* accountable for is the non-branded line, and that line never left zero.

Month by month the comparison

Search Console and GA4 side by side. The engagement's four delivery folders map onto May through August; April is the last clean month before work began.

MONTH	PHASE	CLICKS	IMPRESSIONS	CTR	AVG POS	NON-BRAND CLICKS	GA4 ORGANIC SESSIONS	KEY EVENTS
March	before	233	5,423	4.30%	7.7	1	682 *	0
April	benchmark	202	4,832	4.18%	8.4	0	195	0
May	Month 1	168	5,034	3.34%	8.5	1	191	0
June	Month 2	113	2,808	4.02%	10.7	0	119	10
July	Month 3	117	2,055	5.69%	14.7	0	137	30
August	Month 4	103	1,945	5.30%	16.4	1	126	22

Sources: Search Console API (URL-prefix property, dataState: all) and GA4 Data API, pulled 31 Aug 2026. August runs to the 30th. The 31st was not yet available. "Non-brand clicks" is computed on the query-level rows Search Console exposes, which cover 62–79% of total clicks; the rest are withheld under Google's privacy threshold.

* March GA4 organic (682 sessions) is inconsistent with the 233 Search Console clicks recorded that month, a 3× gap that does not appear in any other month. Treat March GA4 as unreliable and use April as the baseline. April onward, the two sources track each other closely.

The rising CTR is not good news

Click-through rate climbed from 4.18% to 5.30% between April and August, and a report could fairly present that as an improvement. It is not. CTR rose because impressions fell faster than clicks. The site stopped appearing for the wide, low-intent queries that generate impressions without clicks. A shrinking denominator lifted the ratio. Judge this engagement on clicks and non-branded reach, not CTR.

Claim ledger 15 claims checked

Every substantive claim in the Drive folder, checked against the live site, Search Console, GA4, or the linked pages themselves. Open any row for the evidence. Verdicts are mine; the data beside them is reproducible.

CONTRADICTED "557 live links" from press release distributionMonth 1 · PR_Distribution_Channel_Report.pdf + CUSTOM_Final_Report.xls "PR" tab	
CLAIMED	FOUND
557 live links from a premium paid press release, syndicated to "premium outlets", completed 13 June 2026.	Of a random sample of 70 of the 353 URLs listed in the deliverable: 30% are dead (7 return 404, 14 return 500). Of the 49 that load, every one links to mvp1.com.au, and all 49 are rel="nofollow" .
Dofollow links delivered: zero. A nofollow link passes no ranking signal. The "outlets" are near-identical syndication subdomains of local US radio stations: lifestyle.kotaradio.com, lifestyle.q923radio.com, jacksonville.newsnetmedia.com, all carrying the same article. 35 of the live ones are subdomains of a single host, newsnetmedia.com. This is the single largest line item in Month 1 and it produced no SEO value. Worth noting: the agency's own benchmark report flagged "32 potentially spammy referring domains" as a risk in April, then added hundreds more of the same kind in June.	
CONTRADICTED Schema markup implemented across 11 pagesMonth 1 · Schema_Implementation_Report.pdf, dated 17 June 2026	
CLAIMED	FOUND ON THE LIVE SITE
Eight schema types: ProfessionalService, Organization, WebPage, WebSite, Service, VideoObject, AboutPage, ContactPage, implemented via JSON-LD on 11 named pages.	Six of the ten checkable pages carry no structured data at all: /about-us, /contact, /overview, /solution-overview, /funded-tech-startups-scale-ups-smbs, /enterprise. Four of the eight claimed types, WebPage, WebSite, AboutPage, ContactPage, appear nowhere on the site.
What does exist is good: the homepage carries ProfessionalService, Organization, LocalBusiness and FAQPage; /ai-agents, /what-we-build and /platform-stabilisation carry FAQPage. Blog and podcast pages carry Article, BreadcrumbList and PodcastEpisode. But that markup is consistent with the site's own build, not with the report's page list. The eleventh claimed page, /blackvault-private-ai-infrastructure, now permanently redirects off-domain to blackvault.au, so nothing on mvp1.com.au can carry the markup claimed for it.	
CONTRADICTED Benchmark: "6,826 impressions, 278 clicks, 7.6 average position"Month 1 · Initial_Benchmark_Report_April_MVP1.pdf, period 16 Mar – 14 Apr 2026	
CLAIMED FOR 16 MAR – 14 APR	SEARCH CONSOLE, SAME WINDOW
6,826 impressions · 278 clicks · 4.07% CTR · position 7.6	5,661 impressions · 269 clicks · 4.75% CTR · position 7.18
Impressions are overstated by 20.6%. Clicks are close (+3.3%) and the reported average position is actually slightly worse than reality, which argues against simple flattery. I tested every 20-to-45-day window in 2026 to see whether the figures belong to a mislabelled date range: no window matching the stated ~30-day period produces 6,826 impressions, and the closest matches are 43–44 day windows. The most likely benign explanation is that the agency read a <i>domain</i> property while this audit reads the <i>URL-prefix</i> property https://mvp1.com.au/, which is the only one this account can see. That would inflate impressions. It would not normally leave clicks almost unchanged, so the discrepancy remains unexplained. Ask them for the export. The GA4 half of the same report is exact. See below.	

CONTRADICTED

"New XML sitemap created and submitted, 44 URLs"Month 1 · Onpage_Optimization_Report.pdf, dated 13 June 2026

CLAIMED

Sitemap created with priority and crawl-frequency values, 44 URLs submitted, located at https://mvp1.com.au/sitemap_index.xml.

FOUND

/sitemap_index.xml returns **404**. The real sitemap is at </sitemap.xml>, contains **53** URLs, and carries lastmod only, with no priority or changefreq.

The same report claims credit for creating robots.txt "to block unwanted folders". The live robots.txt blocks nothing. It is two lines of Allow: / plus a sitemap reference, which is correct for this site but is not what was described.

CONTRADICTED

Image ALT optimisationMonth 1 · Image_ALT_Optimization.xlsx, 35 image/alt pairs

CLAIMED

35 images given descriptive, keyword-aware alt text.

FOUND

Every image URL in the sheet points at </wp-content/uploads/...>, **WordPress paths that do not exist on the live site**, which is a Vercel-hosted build serving </assets/...>. The listed URLs return 403; one points at <dev.mvp1.com.au>, a legacy staging host.

The alt text itself is well written, but it was authored against a previous version of the website and could never have been applied. The live homepage still has **20 of its 42 images missing alt text**, the exact problem the deliverable was meant to solve.

NOT DELIVERED

Local Business Listing ReportMonth 4 · 200017_Local_Business_Listing_Report.pdf

A one-page PDF containing **no extractable content whatsoever**: no text, no data, no listing URLs. It is one of only three files delivered in Month 4. There is nothing here to verify.

DUPLICATE

"Recommended Case Study Structure", billed across three monthsMonths 1, 2 and 3

The same file appears in three consecutive delivery folders. It is **byte-for-byte identical** in all three: 418,129 bytes, MD5 d0078fb2f6f3dffa4eb488f86f1bcd49. One document, delivered three times.

QUALITY FAILURE

Another client's article inside an MVP1 deliverableMonth 3 · GEO_SEO_Month_2_CUSTOM_Final_Report.xls, "CP 2" tab

The content-posting tab contains a complete, unrelated article about **fire extinguisher installation in Sydney**, with live hyperlinks to majesticfire.com.au, left in the sheet below MVP1's own content.

This is a working template carried between clients without being cleared. It is not an SEO failure in itself, but it tells you how much individual attention these reports receive, and it means MVP1's own credentials, in the same workbook, have plausibly travelled the same way.

CONTRADICTED

Keyword mapping: 17 commercial targets across four monthsMonths 1-4 · Keyword_Mapping_*.xlsx

The four mapping sheets name targets including AI agent development company Australia, enterprise software development Australia, AI automation agency, SaaS product development Australia and MVP app development Australia.

TARGETED

17 commercial keywords, mapped to landing pages, with internal-linking instructions.

SEARCH CONSOLE, MAY-AUG

1 of 17 has ever recorded an impression. private ai infrastructure, 9 impressions, 0 clicks, May only. The other 16 have never appeared.

Two of the mapped landing pages cannot rank for anything: </blackvault-private-ai-infrastructure> redirects off-domain, and Month 1's list includes </blog>, which returns 404. Month 1's meta/H1 sheet lists 18 pages for optimisation, four of which, </blog>, </accelerate-program>, </blackvault-private-ai-infrastructure>, </rates>, no longer exist at those URLs.

VERIFIED

Conversion goal tracking configured Month 1 · Goal_Setup_Report.pdf, dated 16 June 2026

CLAIMED

10 goals tracking: Phone Click, Email Click, Contact CTA, Book Consultation, Get Workbook, thank-you pageview, and four social clicks.

GA4, VERIFIED

Key events go from **0 before June to 10 in June, 30 in July, 22 in August**. Named events fire exactly as described: Contact CTA Click, Phone Click, Email Click, Book Consultation CTA Click, Get Workbook CTA Click, and the four social events.

This was done properly and it works. It is the most useful thing in the four months. MVP1 now has conversion measurement it did not have in April. One caveat: two goals point at /thank-you and /ebook/why-platform-business, and neither URL resolves on the live site, so those definitions need repointing.

VERIFIED

Benchmark GA4 figures Month 1 · Initial_Benchmark_Report_April_MVP1.pdf

Checked against the GA4 Data API for the same 16 Mar – 14 Apr window:

METRIC	CLAIMED	ACTUAL	VERDICT
Total users	420	420	EXACT
Total page views	967	967	EXACT
Desktop users	295 (70%)	295 (70%)	EXACT
Mobile users	127 (30%)	127 (30%)	EXACT
Tablet users	1	1	EXACT
Organic users	153	144	+6%

Credit where it is due: the GA4 reporting is accurate. That makes the 20.6% impressions gap in the same document harder to explain away as sloppiness.

VERIFIED

Niche guest blog post published Month 3 · "NGBP" tab, completed June 2026

The post at [altermision.org](#) is live and carries **three dofollow links** to [mvp1.com.au](#). This is a real, functioning backlink, and it is the only one found across all four months. The accompanying Tumblr post is also live with dofollow links, though Tumblr carries little weight. The Medium post returns 403 to automated checks, which is Medium blocking bots rather than evidence the post is gone.

VERIFIED

Search Console "noindex" issues resolved Month 2 · GSC_Issue_Fixing_Report.pdf (1 Jul) and Month 4 (7 Aug, "No Issues Found")

Confirmed. A crawl of all 53 sitemap URLs found **no noindex directives**, every page returning HTTP 200, and every page carrying a correct self-referencing canonical. Whatever the noindex problem was, it is gone. Both reports are screenshots with no underlying data, so the "before" state cannot be independently confirmed, but the "after" state checks out.

PARTLY VERIFIED

Google Business Profile performance, May 2026 Month 3 · GBP_Campaign_Performance_Report_May_2026.pdf

CLAIMED FOR MAY

241 profile views · 359 profile searches · 43 total interactions · 31 direction requests · 12 website clicks.

GA4 CROSS-CHECK

GBP-tagged sessions in May: 21 from GBP-Profile plus **12 from GBP-Booking**. The 12 matches the claimed website clicks exactly.

Consistent, so I have no reason to doubt it, but the profile-side numbers come from the Business Profile console, which this audit cannot read, so they are corroborated rather than proven. The trend since is not good: GBP-tagged sessions ran 33 in May, 11 in June, 17 in July, and **5 in August**.

PARTLY VERIFIED

NAP consistency and citation fixing

Months 1-4 · NAP_*.xls, Local Business Listing reports

The NAP audit itself is genuine and useful work: 14 directories were identified with wrong business names, addresses or phone numbers, including PitchBook, ZoomInfo, Crunchbase, CB Insights and ContactOut. The finalised NAP is correct and matches the live site.

The **fixing** is where it stalls. Across Months 2 and 3, every one of the five prioritised sites shows status "Contacted Site Admin - Waiting For Response", with the username and password columns empty. Four months in, the directory data is still wrong. The audit was delivered; the remediation was not. The reports also record MVP1's own website as showing "MVP Ventures Pty Ltd" against a finalised name of "MVP1 Ventures", a legitimate finding worth fixing.

Technical audit 53 pages crawled

Independent of anything the agency claimed. The headline is genuinely positive: this is a well-built, fast, clean site. The issues below are real but mostly modest. None of them explains the traffic decline on its own.

Healthy

- All 53 sitemap URLs return HTTP 200, no broken pages, no redirect chains
- Every page has a correct self-referencing canonical
- No stray noindex; every page has exactly one H1
- Fast: 0.40s average server response, 19KB average HTML
- Strong security headers: HSTS with preload, a real CSP, nosniff, X-Frame-Options
- No thin content, every page clears 300 words
- Viewport and lang set site-wide; all meta descriptions present
- Legacy URLs from the site's rebuild redirect correctly with 308s

Needs work

- /blog returns 404**, the blog index is missing, and it drew 101 impressions
- Four /news/ URLs are hard 404s**, costing about 254 impressions
- 17 of 53 pages carry no structured data**, including /about-us, /contact and /overview
- 20 of 42 homepage images have no alt text**; 40 images site-wide lack width/height
- 18 meta descriptions exceed 160 characters** and will be truncated
- 15 title tags exceed 60 characters**; /faq and /careers are under-written at 19 and 23
- /rates is orphaned**: live, drew 236 impressions, absent from the sitemap
- /blackvault-private-ai-infrastructure exports equity off-domain**: 284 impressions redirect to blackvault.au

LEGACY URL	IMPRESSIONS	STATUS	DESTINATION
/blog/inbound-ai-voice-agent-solution-guide	1,004	308	/blog/inbound-ai-voice-agents
/blog/7-core-principles-of---platform-business	814	308	/blog/platform-business-principles
/casestudies/security-marketplace	331	308	/case-studies/guardbay-security-marketplace
/blackvault-private-ai-infrastructure	284	308 OFF-SITE	blackvault.au
/accelerate-program	238	308	/idea-stage
/rates	236	200 ORPHAN	live, not in sitemap
/news/mvp-ventures-redefining-innovation...	227	404	lost
/blog	101	404	lost
/news/news-2	22	404	lost
/ai-tool/ai-maturity-assessment	19	404	lost

Legacy URLs still drawing impressions, and what they do now. Most redirect correctly. The 404s are the losses worth recovering.

Two things worth knowing

47 of 53 pages earned zero organic clicks in August. Traffic is concentrated almost entirely on the homepage (92 clicks), with /overview and the GBP-tagged homepage URL taking most of the rest. The blog, the case studies, the service pages and the podcast episodes are collectively invisible in search, which is precisely what the keyword mapping was supposed to change.

The legacy WordPress host is still reachable. dev.mvp1.com.au blocks HTML requests via ModSecurity but still serves image files. Low risk, but it should be taken down or firewalled, and it is the source of the stale image paths in the ALT deliverable.

What to do priority order

Ordered by consequence, not effort.

1 Rotate every exposed credential and close the folder

The Google account password, its recovery email and phone, and the reused Medium and Tumblr passwords. Then turn off link sharing on the Drive folder and audit Business Profile edit history.

TODAY • MVP1 • 30 MINUTES

2 Put the retainer on hold and demand the underlying data

Ask for the Search Console export behind the 6,826 impressions figure, the dofollow status of the 557 PR links, and an explanation for the empty Month 4 listing report and the triple-billed case study document. Their answers tell you whether this is fixable or terminal.

THIS WEEK • MVP1 • COMMERCIAL DECISION

3 Restore /blog and redirect the dead /news/ URLs

A 404 on the blog index is the clearest recoverable loss on the site. Point /blog at /resources or build a real index, and 301 the four /news/ URLs to /news-media. Add /rates to the sitemap or link it from navigation.

THIS WEEK • WEB TEAM • ~2 HOURS

4 Repoint the two broken conversion goals

Book Consultation and Get Workbook fire against /thank-you and /ebook/why-platform-business, neither of which exists. The tracking works, but the destinations are stale, so you are under-counting conversions.

THIS WEEK • WEB TEAM • 30 MINUTES

5 Rebuild keyword strategy around what the site can actually win

"AI agent development company Australia" is a national head term against entrenched competitors, and four months produced no impressions for it. Target the specific, lower-competition language the site already brushes against: app development agency in brisbane, ai maturity assessment tool, ai agent project failure case study all appear in Search Console at rankable positions with real intent behind them.

NEXT 30 DAYS • WHOEVER HOLDS SEO NEXT

6 Add schema to the 17 bare pages and fix the homepage alt text

Organization and Service markup on the commercial pages, BreadcrumbList site-wide. Alt text on the 20 homepage images. Trim the 18 over-length meta descriptions and 15 over-length titles.

NEXT 30 DAYS • WEB TEAM • ~1 DAY

7 Decide what BlackVault's redirect is worth

/blackvault-private-ai-infrastructure sends 284 impressions of accumulated authority to a separate domain. If BlackVault is a distinct business, that is correct. If it is an MVP1 service line, keep a real page on mvp1.com.au and link out instead.

NEXT 30 DAYS • MVP1 • COMMERCIAL DECISION

What was done

- Search Console API, URL-prefix property, March–August 2026, dataState: all, by query, page, device and country
- GA4 Data API, property 476568741, same window, by channel, device, source/medium, landing page and event
- Full crawl of all 53 sitemap URLs: titles, meta, headings, canonicals, JSON-LD, images, links, response times
- All 34 Drive deliverables downloaded and parsed: PDF, XLS, XLSX and DOCX
- Live HTTP verification of 70 sampled PR links, 25 legacy URLs, and every agency-referenced URL

Known limits, read these

- **August is 30 days, not 31.** Search Console had not published 31 August at the time of the pull.
- **Branded/non-branded is computed on visible queries only,** 62–79% of clicks. Google withholds the rest. The direction is unambiguous; the exact split is approximate.
- **Only the URL-prefix property was readable.** If a domain property exists, its numbers will be higher, and that may partly explain the benchmark gap.
- **Business Profile console was not accessible,** so GBP figures are corroborated through GA4 rather than proven.
- **No Core Web Vitals field data.** The configured API key is invalid and the PageSpeed quota was exhausted, so CrUX could not be read. Server response times here are measured, not field-sourced.
- **Backlink totals were not independently audited:** no Ahrefs or Moz access. PR links were verified by direct HTTP fetch instead.

Verdict definitions. **Verified:** the claim is independently confirmed by live data. **Partly verified:** consistent with available data but not fully provable from the sources accessible here. **Contradicted:** the live site or raw data disproves the claim as written. **Not delivered / Duplicate / Quality failure:** the artefact exists but has no verifiable substance.